

README

Constitution Adoption — start here

Field	Value
Revision	1
Created	2026-08-27
Status	active
Status summary	Reader's guide to how the vasic umbrella inherits the Helix Universal Constitution: where the constitution lives, which parts of the prescribed adoption mechanism are wired, how the inheritance pointer is recognised, how to run the two verifiers, and what still fails.
Scope	Documentation only. This file describes artifacts; it does not add, weaken, or override any rule.
Verifiers described	tests/ test_constitution_inheritance.sh, scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh

§11.4.65 disclosure. This document ships without its .html and .pdf siblings, the same known and disclosed deviation INVENTORY.md records for itself as gap **G8**. It is stated rather than left to be discovered.

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0. The 60-second version

This repository **consumes** a shared, project-agnostic constitution that lives in a git submodule. Nothing from that corpus is copied into this repository. Five files at the repository root — `CLAUDE.md`, `AGENTS.md`, `QWEN.md`, `GEMINI.md`, `Constitution.md` — each open with a `## INHERITED FROM` heading that points at the submodule and declares its rules to apply unconditionally.

Two scripts check that this wiring is real:

```
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh                # 8
    invariants; currently 8 PASS
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh --prove-failure #
    proves the gate can fail
bash scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh --quiet    # the
    full sweep; currently exits 1
```

The sweep **does not pass**, and this documentation does not claim it does. See §6 for the 21 failures and why each one is what it is.

1. What the constitution is, and where it lives

The Helix Universal Constitution is a single, project-agnostic rule corpus maintained in its own repository and consumed here as a git submodule.

Property	Value	Verified by
Path in this repository	submodules/constitution/	git submodule status
Upstream	git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution.git	.gitmodules
Pinned commit	448981ae3498229c734dc60719f4b19f01d7a75f	git submodule status
git describe	v1.0.0-51-g448981a — 51 commits past the only semver tag, i.e. not tag-pinned	git describe
Corpus size	Constitution.md — 11,101 lines / 1,534,735 bytes	wc -l, ls -l
Anchor count	261 distinct numbered anchors (mechanically counted in <u>INVENTORY.md §2</u>)	INVENTORY.md

The files that matter most, all resolved **by reference** and never copied:

What	Canonical path
The universal constitution	submodules/constitution/ Constitution.md
Claude Code carrier	submodules/constitution/ CLAUDE.md (654,214 bytes)
Codex / Cursor / Aider / OpenCode / Crush / Kimi CLI carrier	submodules/constitution/ AGENTS.md
Qwen Code carrier	submodules/constitution/QWEN.md
Gemini CLI carrier	submodules/constitution/ GEMINI.md
Parent-walk resolver	submodules/constitution/ find_constitution.sh
Consumer scaffolds	submodules/constitution/ templates/
The gate fleet	submodules/constitution/ scripts/gates/

If submodules/constitution/ is empty it was never initialised. Initialise it with `git submodule update --init submodules/constitution` — and note that this is a mutating git command, so an agent needs operator authorization first.

1.1 The path note that trips everyone up

The constitution’s **own prose and templates** use a top-level constitution/ directory as their worked example — e.g. constitution/CLAUDE.md, @constitution/CLAUDE.md. **This repository does not use that layout.** It places the submodule at submodules/constitution/, the §11.4.28 dependency-layout form (owned submodules grouped under a root submodules/ directory).

Both layouts are first-class: submodules/constitution/find_constitution.sh searches for either, walking up from any nested depth. Line 42:

```
local rels=( "constitution" "submodules/constitution" )
```

Translation rule. Wherever a quoted universal clause says constitution/<file>, the real path in this checkout is submodules/constitution/<file>. That substitution is the only systematic edit made when the project Constitution.md was instantiated from submodules/constitution/templates/Constitution.project.md.template, and the project Constitution.md says so in its own path note.

Locate the submodule from anywhere:

```
bash submodules/constitution/find_constitution.sh
```

2. The five-part adoption mechanism, with status

The constitution **prescribes** how a project adopts it. Nothing here was invented. INVENTORY.md §5 is the source that identified the mechanism as five parts and quoted each one; the quotations below are from submodules/constitution/README.md (“How to consume”) and submodules/constitution/Constitution.md.

The status column reflects what is on disk **today**, which is later than the state INVENTORY.md recorded — INVENTORY.md was written before parts 2, 4 and most of 5 landed, and still says so.

#	Part	Prescribed by	Status today
1	Add the submodule	README.md “How to consume” §1	DONE

#	Part	Prescribed by	Status today
2	Wire the inheritance	README.md §2 + §11.4.35 invariant 6	DONE
3	Instantiate the templates	submodules/constitution/templates/	PARTIAL — only 3 of 5 templates exist upstream
4	Verify with an automated test	README.md §4 + §1.1	DONE
5	The post-pull transaction	§11.4.164 + §11.4.32	PARTIAL — sweep exists; cascade verifier and hook wiring do not

Part 1 — add the submodule → DONE

```
git submodule add git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/
    HelixConstitution.git constitution

# Pin to a tag for reproducibility (recommended)
cd constitution
git checkout v1.0.0          # whatever the current stable
                             tag is
```

Done, at submodules/constitution rather than constitution — the layout find_constitution.sh explicitly supports (see §1.1).

Honest boundary. The quoted step recommends pinning to a tag. This repository pins a **commit** (448981ae..), which git describe resolves to v1.0.0-51-g448981a — 51 commits past the tag. The pin is reproducible and the inheritance test asserts it (invariant I2), but it is not the tag-pin the snippet recommends.

Part 2 — wire the inheritance → DONE

Add a clearly-marked pointer at the top of your project's root CLAUDE.md:

```
## INHERITED FROM constitution/CLAUDE.md
```

All rules in ``constitution/CLAUDE.md`` (and the ``constitution/Constitution.md``)

it references) apply unconditionally. Project-specific rules below extend them.

@constitution/CLAUDE.md

and its normative form, §11.4.35 invariant 6:

1. @constitution/CLAUDE.md import (Claude-Code-style) and the pointer-block fallback (Aider/Codex/Gemini-style) are **equivalent**. The consumer’s CLAUDE.md MUST start with one of:
- The native import: @constitution/CLAUDE.md
 - The portable pointer-block per the ## INHERITED FROM constitution/CLAUDE.md heading defined in constitution/CLAUDE.md “How inheritance works”.

All five root carriers now open with the pointer block form. The mechanics — and why the pointer was chosen over the import — are §3.

Part 3 — instantiate the templates → PARTIAL

The submodule ships consumer scaffolds at submodules/constitution/templates/. There are exactly three:

Template	Used here for
Constitution.project.md.template	the root Constitution.md
AGENTS.project.md.template	the root AGENTS.md, and the nine-item “Critical base rules restated” block reproduced in all four agent carriers
CLAUDE.project.md.template	the root CLAUDE.md

There is **no** QWEN.project.md.template and **no** GEMINI.project.md.template, even though §11.4.157 makes all five carriers equal. That is a gap in the constitution submodule itself, recorded as **G7b** in INVENTORY.md §8 and repeated in the project Constitution.md; it forces every consuming project to hand-derive two of its five carriers. Per §11.4.26 the fix belongs upstream in HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution, not here.

The nine-item restated block is worth calling out because it looks like a copy of the corpus and is not. It is authored **by the constitution** in `AGENTS.project.md.template` for exactly this purpose (“for agents that don’t follow `@imports`”), so reproducing it is the prescribed mechanism. Everything else in the carriers is a pointer.

Part 4 — verify with an automated test → DONE

Every consuming project should ship a test that verifies the constitution submodule is present, at the expected pinned revision, and that the project’s `CLAUDE.md` / `AGENTS.md` / `QWEN.md` / `Constitution` all reference the submodule.

Implemented as `tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh`, 8 invariants, plus a `--prove-failure` paired-mutation mode that satisfies §1.1 (“a gate that cannot be made to fail is a sham”). See §5.

Honest boundary. The quoted step names two reference implementations (the `ATMOSphere` and `Herald` projects’ tests). Neither repository is present in this checkout, so neither was available to copy. The gate’s own header says so and cites, per invariant, the clause or shipped artifact each assertion comes from.

Part 5 — the post-pull transaction → PARTIAL

§11.4.32:

Validation sweep contract. The sweep is implemented as `scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh` (canonical name) which:

1. Re-runs the existing governance-cascade verifier (`scripts/verify-governance-cascade.sh`) covering every §11.9 + `CONST-*` anchor across every owned submodule (recursive per `CONST-047`).
2. For each rule whose enforcement gate is implementable programmatically [...] the sweep runs the corresponding gate against the post-pull tree.
3. Any failure produces a directed `FAIL` entry naming the rule [...]

§11.4.164:

The canonical hook script lives at constitution/scripts/post_update_hook.sh and is inherited by reference (§11.4.28) — NEVER copied locally.

What exists and what does not:

Piece	State
scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh (step 2 + 3)	exists — discovers gates dynamically, reports directed FAIL entries
scripts/verify-governance-cascade.sh (step 1)	does not exist ; the sweep prints an explicit SKIP naming it — recorded as open conflict OC-3
submodules/constitution/scripts/post_update_hook.sh	present in the submodule, invoked from nowhere in this repository — INVENTORY gap G12 's sibling condition
§11.4.75 five-layer git-hook ritual	absent — .git/hooks/ contains only git's own *.sample files (0 non-sample hooks) — INVENTORY gap G5

3. How inheritance actually works here

3.1 The literal the gates key on

The whole mechanism rests on one exact string: a line-anchored heading

```
## INHERITED FROM <anything>
```

at the top of a carrier, **outside any fenced code block**. A file carrying it is a §11.4.35 *pointer-inheritance consumer*: it inherits every universal anchor by reference and is not required to restate anchor text verbatim.

The single canonical predicate lives at submodules/constitution/scripts/gates/lib/pointer_carrier.sh. It is eight lines wrapping four lines of awk:

```
is_pointer_carrier() {  
    awk '  
        BEGIN { fenced = 0; found = 0 }
```



```

    /^(``|~~)/ { fenced = !fenced; next }
    !fenced && /^## INHERITED FROM / { found = 1; exit }
    END { exit !found }
' "$1"
}

```

Every `cm_covenant_114*_propagation.sh` gate sources it, and so does this repository's `tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh` (invariant I4) — by reference, never by copy. The practical effect, from a real run of one gate against this repository:

```

» POINTER-INHERITANCE-SKIP AGENTS.md — §11.4.35 pointer consumer
(inherits 11.4.213 by pointer)
» POINTER-INHERITANCE-SKIP CLAUDE.md — §11.4.35 pointer consumer
(inherits 11.4.213 by pointer)
» POINTER-INHERITANCE-SKIP GEMINI.md — §11.4.35 pointer consumer
(inherits 11.4.213 by pointer)
» POINTER-INHERITANCE-SKIP QWEN.md — §11.4.35 pointer consumer
(inherits 11.4.213 by pointer)

```

Without the heading those four lines would read `MISSING ... lacks anchor literal 11.4.213`, once for every one of the 17 propagation gates.

3.2 The fenced-code-block trap the predicate guards against

Two details in that `awk` are load-bearing, and the file's own header explains why each exists.

Fence tracking. A bare `grep -qE '^## INHERITED FROM '` would false-match the “How inheritance works” **example** that the canonical constitution mirrors quote inside a fenced block. That fenced text is a *carrier quoting the heading* — a full-restating mirror that must still be checked for every anchor — not a real pointer. A predicate fooled by it would silently skip the canonical files themselves. The `awk` therefore toggles a fenced flag on every fence-opening line — backtick **or** tilde — and only recognises the heading outside a fence. The tilde form is tracked too: a predicate that toggled on backticks alone would be fooled by a `~~~`-fenced decoy, and there is a golden-bad fixture for exactly that.

The trap is not hypothetical. `submodules/constitution/CLAUDE.md` line 91 is a literal, column-zero `## INHERITED FROM constitution/CLAUDE.md` — sitting inside the fence opened on line 90:

How inheritance works

A consuming project's root ``CLAUDE.md`` MUST start with a clearly-marked inheritance pointer:

```
```markdown
INHERITED FROM constitution/CLAUDE.md
...
```
```

grep says pointer. The predicate says otherwise, and can be checked directly:

```
$ . submodules/constitution/scripts/gates/lib/pointer_carrier.sh
$ is_pointer_carrier submodules/constitution/CLAUDE.md; echo $?
1
```

Had it said 0, every propagation gate would have skipped the canonical CLAUDE.md — the one file in the fleet that must be checked against every single anchor.

The ^ line-start anchor. The live constitution/CLAUDE.md mentions ``## INHERITED FROM constitution/CLAUDE.md`` mid-line, inside backticks, in prose. A substring match would read that as a pointer heading and skip a full mirror. The ^ anchor is what stops it, and again there is a golden-bad fixture named after exactly that shape.

The predicate ships its own runnable proof:

```
bash submodules/constitution/scripts/gates/lib/pointer_carrier.sh
--selftest
```

It exercises five fixtures — one golden-good, three golden-bad decoys (fenced carrier, mid-line backticked mention, ~~~~fenced), one negative control — and prints `pointer_carrier.sh selftest: PASS (5/5)`. The inheritance test runs this **first**, as invariant I7, on the §11.4.201(7)(b) principle that a null result is not evidence until the instrument is proven to see.

3.3 Why the pointer block and not the native @import

§11.4.35 invariant 6 declares the two forms **equivalent** — a consumer carrier must start with either the native `@constitution/CLAUDE.md import` **or** the portable `## INHERITED FROM` pointer block. This repository chose the pointer, and the reason is stated in the carriers rather than left implicit:

submodules/constitution/CLAUDE.md is **654,214 bytes** and submodules/constitution/Constitution.md is **1,534,735 bytes**. A native @import auto-loads the imported file into the agent's context at session start, so every session — including ones that never touch governance — would begin by loading roughly 654 KB before any work starts. The pointer form carries the same authority at no standing cost, and it is the form the constitution's own propagation gates recognise via the predicate above.

The trade-off is real and worth stating: an agent that does **not** resolve pointers sees only the nine restated base rules, not the corpus. That is why each carrier says, in as many words, that a rule absent from the carriers is not absent — read it from submodules/constitution/Constitution.md before acting.

Read one anchor instead of the whole corpus:

```
grep -n '^### §11.4.35 ' submodules/constitution/Constitution.md
awk '/^### §11.4.35 /{f=1} f{print} f&&/^### §11.4.36 /{exit}' \
    submodules/constitution/Constitution.md
```

4. The §11.4.157 five-carrier lockstep

§11.4.157 (submodules/constitution/Constitution.md:9566):

GEMINI.md is a FIRST-CLASS governance context carrier, EQUAL to CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / QWEN.md — NEVER an optional or best-effort sibling. Every governance addition or edit MUST land in ALL FIVE carriers in lockstep: the canonical Constitution.md PLUS each per-agent mirror CLAUDE.md + AGENTS.md + QWEN.md + GEMINI.md [...] **(B) No silent drift.** A GEMINI.md whose highest rule number lags the other mirrors is a §11.4.157 violation [...] **(D) Consumer projects too.** The lockstep binds the consuming project's repository-root context files [...] a project that maintains the other three but not GEMINI.md is non-compliant.

The clause exists because of a real incident recorded in its own forensic case study: GEMINI.md once drifted fourteen mandates behind the other three mirrors, so a Gemini-CLI agent was operating under an out-of-date constitution while the fleet believed the rule was universally in force.

How this repository satisfies it. All four root agent carriers are 197 lines each. Lines 1–23 differ by design — the title, which base file the carrier points at, and one sentence naming which agent reads it. **Line 24 onward is byte-identical across all four**, which is what makes drift structurally impossible rather than merely discouraged: a governance edit either lands in all four or the check below fails.

Verify it in one line — it must print 1:

```
for f in CLAUDE.md AGENTS.md QWEN.md GEMINI.md; do tail -n +24 "$f" | sha256sum | cut -d' ' -f1; done | sort -u | wc -l
```

Real output, this checkout:

1

The shared digest is

d26e2c31252d8837870b559c90d0650709f903b74ceaedc45944bb623fa4f836. A 2 means a carrier drifted; `diff <(tail -n +24 CLAUDE.md) <(tail -n +24 GEMINI.md)` names what.

The fifth carrier, `Constitution.md`, is **not** byte-identical to the other four and is not meant to be — it is the project constitution, not a per-agent mirror. What binds it is invariants I3/I4/I5 of the inheritance test: it must exist, open with the pointer heading, and name `submodules/constitution/`.

Not specified. §11.4.157 mandates lockstep but does not prescribe *how* a consumer proves it, and names no byte-identity check. The line-24 split and the one-liner above are this project's chosen mechanism, not a universal requirement.

5. Running the verifiers

Two commands. Both are read-only: neither writes to this repository, neither writes into any submodule working tree, and neither runs a mutating git command.

5.1 `tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh` — the inheritance gate

```
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh
```

Real output, this checkout:

```

CM-CONSTITUTION-INHERITANCE: checking <ext-volume-host>/Projects/
vasic
  PASS I7 PREDICATE-NOT-BLIND – pointer_carrier.sh --selftest:
pointer_carrier.sh selftest: PASS (5/5)
  PASS I1 SUBMODULE-PRESENT – canonical root complete at
submodules/constitution/ (§11.4.35)
  PASS I2 PINNED-REVISION – submodules/constitution HEAD ==
pinned gitlink 448981ae3498229c734dc60719f4b19f01d7a75f
  PASS I3 FIVE-CARRIERS – CLAUDE.md AGENTS.md QWEN.md GEMINI.md
Constitution.md all present (§11.4.157)
  PASS I4 POINTER-INHERITANCE – all five carriers open with a
real, non-fenced '## INHERITED FROM ' heading (§11.4.35 inv. 6)
  PASS I5 SUBMODULE-REFERENCED – all five carriers name
'submodules/constitution/'
  PASS I6 ANCHOR-PRESENT – '### §11.4 End-user quality
guarantee' present in the inherited corpus
  PASS I8 PROPAGATION-GATES – 17/17
cm_covenant_114_*_propagation gates PASS on the root carriers
-----
CM-CONSTITUTION-INHERITANCE: 8 PASS, 0 SKIP, 0 FAIL (root <ext-
volume-host>/Projects/vasic)
  CM-CONSTITUTION-INHERITANCE: PASS – constitution inheritance is
wired

```

Exit code 0.

The eight invariants, in the order they run:

| Invariant | Asserts | Clause |
|-------------------------|--|----------------------------|
| I7 PREDICATE-NOT-BLIND | the pointer predicate’s own 5-fixture selftest passes, before anything relies on it | §11.4.201(7)(b) |
| I1 SUBMODULE-PRESENT | the canonical root’s six files are present and non-empty | §11.4.35 |
| I2 PINNED-REVISION | the submodule’s HEAD equals the gitlink recorded in this repository’s index | README “How to consume” §4 |
| I3 FIVE-CARRIERS | all five root carriers exist and are non-empty | §11.4.157 |
| I4 POINTER-INHERITANCE | each carries a real, non-fenced pointer heading — or a native @import | §11.4.35 inv. 6 |
| I5 SUBMODULE-REFERENCED | each names submodules/constitution/ | README “How to consume” §4 |

| Invariant | Asserts | Clause |
|-------------------------|---|--|
| I6 ANCHOR-PRESENT | the inherited corpus still carries
§11.4 End-user quality
guarantee | the exact literal
meta_test_inheritance.sh
deletes |
| I8
PROPAGATION-GATES | all 17
cm_covenant_114_*_propagation.sh
gates pass against the four root
carriers in isolation | §11.4.35 inv. 5 |

Note what I8 does **not** cover. It stages copies of the four root carriers into a temp directory and points the gate family there, so its verdict is about *this project's own carriers*. Carriers belonging to third-party repositories that happen to be reachable from the umbrella are out of I8's scope by construction — they are still reported, and still fail, in the full sweep (§6).

--root <dir> and --quiet are also accepted.

5.2 --prove-failure — the §1.1 paired mutation proof

A gate that always passes proves nothing. §1.1: a gate that cannot be made to fail “is a sham and must be rewritten”. This mode builds a throwaway **copy** of the governance surface in a `mktemp -d sandbox`, confirms the unmutated copy passes (the golden-good control, without which “the mutations failed” would be meaningless), then applies four single-point mutations one at a time and asserts the gate fails on each.

```
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh --prove-failure
```

Real output, this checkout:

```
CM-CONSTITUTION-INHERITANCE §1.1 PAIRED MUTATION PROOF
  sandbox: /tmp/.private/milosvasic/tmp.YfGy7PxL8j (every
  mutation below is applied to a COPY;
  neither this repository nor any submodule working tree is
  written to)
  -----
    CONTROL golden-good - unmutated sandbox copy PASSes (rc=0)
    M1 pointer-stripped - root CLAUDE.md loses its '## INHERITED
FROM ' pointer heading -> gate FAILED (rc=1), as it must [I4 +
I8]
    M2 carrier-deleted - root GEMINI.md deleted (five-carrier
lockstep broken) -> gate FAILED (rc=1), as it must [I3 +
I4 + I5]
    M3 anchor-deleted - '### §11.4 ...' anchor deleted from the
inherited corpus -> gate FAILED (rc=1), as it must [I6]
    M4 canonical-emptied - submodules/constitution/GEMINI.md
```

emptied (canonical root gap) -> gate FAILED (rc=1), as it must
[I1]

CM-CONSTITUTION-INHERITANCE §1.1 MUTATION PROOF: PASS – control
passed and all 4 mutations were caught

Exit code 0. The sandbox path changes on every run.

M3 deserves a note: it is the same mutation submodules/constitution/
meta_test_inheritance.sh applies — deleting the ### §11.4 anchor line
— except that harness mutates the **real** submodules/constitution/
Constitution.md in place and restores it afterwards. This mode applies
it to a copy instead, so the gate is proven non-bluff against the identical
regression without ever writing into a submodule working tree.

5.3 scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh — the §11.4.32 sweep

```
bash scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh          # full
    per-gate output
bash scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh --quiet  # one
    line per gate; FAIL detail always shown
bash scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh --list   # show
    what would run, run nothing, exit 0
```

Gates are **discovered, never hardcoded** — find ... -name '*.sh' under
submodules/constitution/scripts/gates/. Pull a new gate from
upstream and the sweep picks it up with no edit here. That is a direct
response to §11.4.32's anti-bluff clause: “A sweep that exits PASS
without actually running every implementable gate is a §11.4.32
violation.”

Each gate's invocation is resolved **from the gate itself**, because the
family overloads --root for two different things: a gate whose usage
header says --root <consumer-root> or <project-root> gets the project
root, one that says --root <constitution-root> gets submodules/
constitution, and one with no --root in its header runs on its own
defaults. --selftest and selfcheck <tmpdir> are used where the script
documents them. Every resolved argv is printed, so a reader can check
the resolution rather than trust it.

This run takes minutes, not seconds. GATE_TIMEOUT (default 900s) caps
each gate when coreutils timeout is on PATH; when it is not, the sweep
says so rather than pretending a cap is in force.

Real output — bash scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh --
quiet, this checkout, constitution HEAD
448981ae3498229c734dc60719f4b19f01d7a75f:

```
=====
§11.4.32 VALIDATION SWEEP – verify-all-constitution-rules.sh
=====
project root      : <ext-volume-host>/Projects/vasic
constitution      : <ext-volume-host>/Projects/vasic/submodules/
constitution
constitution HEAD : 448981ae3498229c734dc60719f4b19f01d7a75f
gates discovered  : 57 (dynamically, under scripts/gates/**)
per-gate timeout  : 900s

---- STEP 1 – governance-cascade verifier (§11.4.32 step 1)
-----
» STEP1 SKIP – scripts/verify-governance-cascade.sh does not exist
in this
repository. §11.4.32 step 1 requires the sweep to
re-run it;
writing it is outstanding work. This is an explicit
SKIP with
a reason (§11.4.3), NOT a pass, and it is recorded
as open
conflict OC-3 in Constitution.md.

---- STEP 2 – every gate under submodules/constitution/scripts/
gates --
PASS rc=0 656ms
cm_build_on_source_proven_not_test_side_mutation_test.sh (gate
defaults)
PASS rc=0 11ms
cm_build_on_source_proven_not_test_side.sh (gate
defaults)
PASS rc=0 56079ms
cm_cli_agent_plugins_wired_mutation_test.sh (gate
defaults)
PASS rc=0 12255ms
cm_cli_agent_plugins_wired.sh --root
<ext-volume-host>/Projects/vasic/submodules/constitution --quiet
PASS rc=0 526ms
cm_continuum_resume_engine_present_mutation_test.sh (gate
defaults)
FAIL rc=1 1228ms
cm_continuum_resume_engine_present.sh --root
<ext-volume-host>/Projects/vasic/submodules/constitution --quiet
FAIL rc=1 519ms
cm_covenant_114_162_propagation.sh --root
<ext-volume-host>/Projects/vasic --quiet
```

[...] 48 further gate lines elided for

length [...]

```
FAIL    rc=1          70ms
cm_track_branch_label.sh                --
quiet
PASS    rc=0          308ms
cm_version_increment_on_deploy_mutation_test.sh    (gate
defaults)
PASS    rc=0          38ms
cm_version_increment_on_deploy.sh            (gate
defaults)
PASS    rc=0          650ms
gate_ledger.sh
selfcheck <scratch>
PASS    rc=0          106ms  lib/
pointer_carrier.sh                      --selftest
```

---- STEP 2b – project-side gates

```
-----
PASS    rc=0          2275ms  tests/
test_constitution_inheritance.sh          --root
<root> --quiet
```

SUMMARY

```
=====
gates run          : 58
  PASS             : 37
  FAIL (rc=1)      : 21
  ERROR (rc!=0,1)  : 0
$11.4.32 step 1    : skip
=====
```

FAILED:

```

x  cm_continuum_resume_engine_present.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_162_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_167_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_176_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_187_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_191_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_196_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_199_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_200_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_201_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_202_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_207_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_213_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_230_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_231_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_232_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_233_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_covenant_114_235_propagation.sh
x
x  cm_gate_ledger_ratchet.sh
```

```
cm_track_branch_label_mutation_test.sh
cm_track_branch_label.sh
```

```
=====
x
DETAIL – full output of every non-PASS gate
=====
===== cm_continuum_resume_engine_present.sh [FAIL rc=1]
      argv: --root <ext-volume-host>/Projects/vasic/submodules/
x
constitution --quiet
      FOUND      project-specific literal(s) inside the engine
(decoupling violation):
                  submodules/continuum/test/e2e/e2e_test.go
-----
      CM-CONTINUUM-RESUME-ENGINE-PRESENT: FAIL – one or more checks
x
failed (see above)
```

[...] the other 20 FAIL details elided for
length [...]

```
=====
      SWEEP: FAIL – 21 FAIL + 0 ERROR out of 58 gate(s).
```

Before treating any of these as a regression, read
Constitution.md -> 'Known-excluded gate findings'
which names the five third-party / staged carriers the propagation
gates report, and the four failures internal to the constitution
submodule's own tree. Those are recorded, NOT suppressed: they
still
FAIL here and they still make this sweep exit non-zero.

Exit code 1. The transcript above is the real run, trimmed only where
marked; elapsed times vary per run. The full run wrote 398 lines. --
quiet still prints every FAIL in full — the elisions above are this
document's, not the sweep's.

Two counts to note. gates discovered : 57 is the scripts found under
scripts/gates/**; gates run : 58 adds this repository's own tests/
test_constitution_inheritance.sh in step 2b. And step 1 is skip, not
pass — the sweep never counts a missing verifier as a passing one.

5.4 The exit-code contract

Both scripts use the same three-value contract, and neither ever treats
a non-zero as “close enough”.

| Exit | tests/
test_constitution_inheritance.sh | scripts/verify-
all-
constitution-
rules.sh |
|------|---|---|
| 0 | every invariant holds — or, in --
prove-failure, the control passed
and all four mutations were
caught | every discovered
gate exited 0 |
| 1 | at least one invariant FAILED — or
a mutation did not make the gate
fail, i.e. this gate is a bluff gate | at least one gate
FAILED (rc=1) or
ERRORed |
| 2 | environment error: root not
found, canonical predicate
unreadable, gate family not found | the sweep could
not run at all:
root missing,
submodule not
initialised, gates
directory absent,
zero gates
discovered |

Two rules the sweep applies that are easy to get wrong:

- **An rc=2 gate is an ERROR, never a pass.** §11.4.201(7)(b): a blind instrument produces no evidence. ERRORS are counted separately and still make the sweep exit 1.
- **A known-excluded finding still FAILs.** Nothing is suppressed. Exclusion (see §6) means “not ours to fix”; it is a note for the reader, never a verdict change.

6. Current honest status — 37 PASS / 21 FAIL

The sweep does not pass. It exits 1. Do not read anything in this directory as a compliance claim.

58 gates run: **37 PASS, 21 FAIL, 0 ERROR**, plus §11.4.32 step 1 recorded as an explicit **SKIP with a reason**. The 58 are the 57 scripts discovered under submodules/constitution/scripts/gates/** plus this repository’s own tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh.

The 21 failures decompose exactly, with nothing left over:

A. 17 propagation gates → the same five carriers, every time

All 17 `cm_covenant_114*_propagation.sh` gates (anchors 162, 167, 176, 187, 191, 196, 199, 200, 201, 202, 207, 213, 230, 231, 232, 233, 235) fail, and each reports the **same five** carriers as MISSING. $17 \times 5 = 85$ MISSING lines in the sweep transcript, and no sixth carrier appears anywhere. (Counted from the run above: 12 of the 17 are the legacy bare-literal gates, reporting “*lacks anchor literal 11.4.N*”; the other 5 are the fence-aware §11.4.227(B) block-integrity gates, reporting “*zero 11.4.N block-starts*”. $12 \times 5 + 5 \times 5 = 85$.)

| Carrier | Owning repository | Why it is what it is |
|---|---|--|
| <code>milosvasic.ru/Upstreamable/AGENTS.md</code> | <code>red-elf/Upstreamable</code> — third-party, and a gitlink of the <code>milosvasic.ru</code> submodule (a fourth-level repository) | project <code>Constitution.md</code> §103: not owned, not pushed, never edited from here |
| <code>milosvasic.ru/Upstreamable/CLAUDE.md</code> | same | §103 |
| <code>submodules/superspec/examples/static-landing-page/CLAUDE.md</code> | <code>WangX0111/superspec</code> — third-party | §103 — a vendored example fixture of someone else’s project |
| <code>.specify/extensions/superspec/examples/static-landing-page/CLAUDE.md</code> | vendored copy of the same <code>superspec</code> fixture | §103 |
| <code>vasic.digital/QWEN.md</code> | <code>vasic-digital/vasic-digital.github.io</code> — owned | §102 — the fix is staged, not applied |

Four of the five are third-party. Writing a governance carrier into a repository this project neither owns nor pushes to would be editing someone else’s tree to make a gate go green.

One is ours. `vasic.digital/QWEN.md` exists (55 lines) and references no anchor and no constitution. Its fix is prepared at `propagation/vasic.digital/QWEN.insert-block.md` and awaits operator application, because §3 of the universal constitution requires the submodule commit and push to land **before** the parent captures the pointer — so

the umbrella never writes a carrier into an owned submodule’s working tree. The procedure is [propagation/APPLY.md](#); read [propagation/RISKS.md](#) first.

That is also why every prepared carrier in `propagation/` carries a `.staged` suffix. The gates discover carriers by **exact filename**, so a draft named `CLAUDE.md` sitting inside this repository would be counted as a real carrier and would itself fail the gate.

B. 4 gates failing inside the constitution submodule’s own tree

These are failures **of the constitution repository**, not of this repository’s adoption. They cannot be fixed from here without writing into a submodule working tree, and per §11.4.26 they belong upstream in `HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution`.

| Gate | Finding |
|---|--|
| <code>cm_continuum_resume_engine_present.sh</code> | a project-specific literal inside a reusable engine: <code>submodules/continuum/test/e2e/e2e_test.go</code> — a §11.4.28(B) decoupling violation |
| <code>cm_gate_ledger_ratchet.sh</code> | ratchet violated — <code>unimplemented=432</code> exceeds the checked-in <code>baseline=420</code> |
| <code>cm_track_branch_label.sh</code> | ALIAS-VALIDATION: the labeler yielded <code>xhigh</code> , not the expected synthetic alias |
| <code>cm_track_branch_label_mutation_test.sh</code> | its paired §1.1 mutation test, failing because the gate above fails |

What “excluded” means, precisely

It means **“not this repository’s to fix”**. It does not mean suppressed, waived, or passing. All 21 still FAIL, all 21 still make the sweep exit 1, and the list exists so a reader can tell a structural finding from a new regression — not so anyone can round 21 FAIL down to zero.

The wider gap picture

The sweep is one view. The full audit is [INVENTORY.md](#), whose G-identifiers the project [Constitution.md](#) tracks:

| Gap | State |
|--|--|
| G1 no consumer governance layer | CLOSED — four root agent carriers |
| G2 no inheritance pointer | CLOSED — all five carriers open with <code>## INHERITED FROM</code> |
| G3 no post-pull validation sweep | PARTIAL — sweep exists, cascade verifier does not (OC-3)
OPEN — OC-1 / OC-2, operator decision → PARTIAL (2026-08-27) — decided “ <i>Comply — disable both, enforce locally.</i> ”, then partially reversed the same day . <code>ci.yml</code> → <code>ci.yml.disabled</code> , gates local (umbrella compliant at file level); |
| G4 active CI contradicts §11.4.156 | <code>milosvasic.ru/.github/workflows/pages.yml</code> stays ACTIVE — sole publish path for a production site, a documented deviation, not an override ; <code>vasic.digital</code> non-compliant at the provider level with no file-level remedy. Not CLOSED and will not close. <u>Decision record</u> §0 |
| G5 no §11.4.75 mechanical enforcement layers | OPEN — <code>.git/hooks/</code> holds only <code>*.sample</code> files |
| G6 no <code>helix-deps.yml</code> | CLOSED — <code>helix-deps.yml</code> at the root |
| G7 no propagation to owned submodules | OPEN — staged under <code>propagation/</code> , unapplied |
| G7b no QWEN/GEMINI project templates | OPEN, upstream — a gap in the constitution submodule |
| G8 §11.4.65 markdown export mandate | OPEN — no <code>.html</code> / <code>.pdf</code> siblings anywhere, this file included |
| G9 §11.4.212 README-orphan | |

| Gap | State |
|--|--|
| | OPEN — root README.md links to nothing but the CI badge |
| G10 §4 tag mirroring incomplete | OPEN — v1.8.0 is on milosvasic.ru and vasic.digital only |
| G11 design-toolkit checked out twice | OPEN — declared in helix-deps.yaml; the shas match today |
| G12 §11.4.109 anti-forgetting layer absent | OPEN — the canonical guard script is in the submodule and wired nowhere |

Reading note. The “Known open gaps” section inside the four root carriers was written before helix-deps.yaml and the two verifiers landed, and still lists **G3** and **G6** as open. The table above and the one in the project Constitution.md are the current state. Correcting the carriers is a five-carrier-lockstep edit and is therefore out of scope for a documentation change.

7. Open conflicts — operator decisions, not bugs

The project Constitution.md records three **open conflicts**: places where this repository’s live state contradicts a universal clause and **nobody has decided what to do**. They are deliberately not filed as overrides — an override is an authorization, and no one has given one.

Update 2026-08-27 — OC-1 is decided and closed at file level; OC-2 is decided the other way and stays OPEN. The operator’s first decision was “*Comply — disable both, enforce locally.*” ~~Both workflows are renamed to a non-active-.disabled name per §11.4.156(B), and the gates move to a local pre-push hook.~~ **That was partially reversed the same day.** pages.yml turned out to be the *sole* publish path for a live production website (build_type: "workflow"; no gh-pages branch, no docs/ folder, Jekyll source at the root, and _tools/deploy-langs.sh merely pushes source and waits for that workflow). The operator’s overriding directive, verbatim: “***Make sure all pages websites work flawlessly! No website can be broken! All websites we have here are running deployed in production!***”

Net state: `.github/workflows/ci.yml` → `ci.yml.disabled`, gates in a local pre-push hook — OC-1 resolved by compliance at file level. `milosvasic.ru/.github/workflows/pages.yml` is **ACTIVE and stays active** — OC-2 remains **open as a permanent documented deviation**. A third surface, **OC-2b**, is added below: `vasic.digital` triggers Pages Actions runs from its provider settings with no workflow file to disable.

Crucially, **the Override §11.4.156 listed below as resolution 2 turned out not to exist**: §11.4.156's closing formula refuses the exemption vocabulary by name, and the inheritance contract (*"extend them — they do NOT weaken or override any universal clause"*) makes a project-local override structurally impossible. **That still holds, and OC-2/OC-2b are not overrides either** — a deviation admits the clause applies and is knowingly unmet; an override would claim it does not apply. No constitution amendment was made. The OC-1/OC-2 text below is kept as the original record. Full decision, honest boundary and loss analysis: **DECISION-11-4-156-COMPLY.md §0. OC-2, OC-2b and OC-3 all remain open** — OC-3 genuinely undecided, OC-2 and OC-2b decided-and-accepted rather than resolved.

The template `Constitution.project.md.template` offers `## Overrides` and nothing else; an "Open conflicts" section is **not specified** by it. It is an addition, marked as such in the project `Constitution.md`, because §11.4.6 forbids reporting a state that was not verified and §11.4.156 names silence as the one option it does not allow.

OC-1 — active CI at the repository root vs §11.4.156(A) — DECIDED 2026-08-27

Original record retained below. Current state: comply — `ci.yml` renamed to a non-active `.disabled` name, gates relocated to a local pre-push hook. Resolution 2 (Override §11.4.156) is void; see the update banner in §7 and DECISION-11-4-156-COMPLY.md.

§11.4.156(A):

(A) Zero active CI at the repository root. No active `.github/workflows/*.yml|*.yaml`, no `.gitlab-ci.yml`, no `.gitlab/**` pipeline include, nor any equivalent provider config may exist at the ROOT of any governed repository/submodule — the only location a provider executes.

and its closing formula:

Non-compliance is a release blocker regardless of context. No escape hatch — no `--allow-ci`, `--enable-workflow`, `--keep-pipeline`, `--remote-ci-OK`, `--ci-exempt` flag.

Live state. `.github/workflows/ci.yml` exists at this repository's root (9,526 bytes) with live on: push / on: pull_request triggers, and README.md line 3 advertises it with a status badge.

Why it is a conflict of intent, not neglect. §11.4.156 moves enforcement to the local §11.4.75 five-layer git-hook ritual. This repository has **none** of those five layers (gap G5). Disabling the workflow today would delete the only mechanical check that exists here and put nothing in its place.

Three resolutions exist; an agent may pick none of them unilaterally:

1. Disable per §11.4.156(B) (rename to `ci.yml.disabled-local-only`) **and** stand up the §11.4.75 local layers first, so enforcement moves rather than disappears. — **CHOSEN 2026-08-27.**
2. Record an explicit Override §11.4.156 in the project Constitution.md, with the operator's justification. — **This resolution does not exist.** §11.4.156 refuses the exemption vocabulary by name, and a consumer carrier may only extend inherited rules, never weaken them.
3. Keep both and accept the release-blocker state knowingly. — Rejected; §11.4.156 makes non-compliance *"a release blocker regardless of context"*.

~~Nothing in this repository disables, edits, or re-enables that workflow.~~
Superseded: the workflow is being renamed under the decision record.

OC-2 — the same clause, inside an owned submodule —
⚠ OPEN: PERMANENT DOCUMENTED DEVIATION
(2026-08-27)

~~Decided with OC-1: pages.yml renamed to a non-active .disabled name.~~
Reversed the same day, before anything was committed or pushed.
The asymmetry the original note flagged turned out to be the decisive fact, and sharper than recorded: `ci.yml` is a **test** workflow whose enforcement relocates to the local hook, while `pages.yml` is a **deploy** workflow — and `gh api repos/milos85vasic/milosvasic.ru/pages` returns `build_type: "workflow"`, so it is the **sole** publish path for

`https://milosvasic.ru/`. There is no `gh-pages` branch, no `docs/` folder, and the repository root is Jekyll SOURCE, so it cannot be served raw from a branch. `_tools/deploy-langs.sh` is not a substitute — it pushes source, then sleeps waiting for that workflow to run. Disabling it does not relocate a check or downgrade a deploy to manual; it **ends** publishing for a live production site.

Operator’s overriding directive, verbatim: “*Make sure all pages websites work flawlessly! No website can be broken! All websites we have here are running deployed in production!*”

pages.yml is ACTIVE and stays active. `milosvasic.ru` is therefore a **known, documented deviation** from §11.4.156 — **not** an Override §11.4.156, which §11.4.156 forbids by name and which the inheritance contract makes structurally impossible. Never record it as one. The REMOTE-ASYMMETRY.md §9 recommendation to extend an override to this file remains void — there is no override to extend, and this is not one. Full record: DECISION-11-4-156-COMPLY.md §0.

`milosvasic.ru/.github/workflows/pages.yml` is an active root workflow in an **owned** submodule, so §11.4.156(A) and (C) bind it exactly as they bind OC-1. It is listed separately because acting on it means committing inside a submodule working tree, which the project Constitution.md §102 reserves to the operator — and because, unlike OC-1, the operator has decided it will not be acted on.

OC-2b — vasic.digital triggers CI with no workflow file — ⚠ OPEN: NO FILE-LEVEL REMEDY

`vasic.digital` (`vasic-digital/vasic-digital.github.io`) has **no .github/ directory at all**, yet it is §11.4.156-non-compliant: its GitHub Pages source setting alone starts an Actions run on every push. Verified 2026-08-27 — `gh api .../pages` returns `build_type: "legacy"`, and the run list shows `pages build` and `deployment (dynamic/pages/pages-build-deployment)` on 2026-08-27 and 2026-08-10. §11.4.156(A) addresses files at a repository root; there is no file here to disable, so **no change to that tree can make it compliant**. Only the operator, in the Pages UI, could stop the runs, and that would unpublish a production site — which the directive quoted in OC-2 forbids. Recorded, not resolved; and, like OC-2, **not an override**.

Those `build_type` values are dated observations. Re-measure them, and the rest of the provider surface, with `bash scripts/verify-provider-ci.sh` (0 = none found, 1 = confirmed, 2 = could not determine — **not** a pass); the setup wizard runs it as Step 9 and surfaces a confirmed finding as a manual step.

`submodules/superspec/.github/workflows/ci.yml` is deliberately **not** listed: §11.4.156(C) scopes the clause to “*repositories we author + push*”, and `superspec` is third-party.

OC-3 — §11.4.32 step 1 has no cascade verifier to re-run

§11.4.32 step 1 requires the sweep to re-run `scripts/verify-governance-cascade.sh`. That file does not exist in this repository. `scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh` therefore reports step 1 as an explicit **SKIP naming the missing file**, and never counts it as a pass. Writing that verifier is remaining work, not a resolved item.

8. Document index

Everything under `docs/constitution-adoption/`. Line counts as of 2026-08-27.

| File | Lines | What it is |
|------------------------------|-------|---|
| README.md | — | This file. Entry point: mechanism, verifiers, status.

The original read-only gap analysis. Identifies the five-part adoption mechanism and quotes it, surveys agent files across the umbrella and every submodule, and ranks gaps G1–G12 (+G7b). Written before the carriers, manifest and verifiers landed; its per-gap statuses are |
| INVENTORY.md | 1104 | |

| File | Lines | What it is |
|-----------------------------|-------|--|
| | | historical, its quotations and measurements are not. |
| <u>INDEX-COVERAGE.md</u> | 489 | Verified CodeGraph + Lumen index-coverage report for the checkout.
Adjacent evidence, not part of the adoption chain: it is what proves which trees the code-intelligence indexers actually reached. |
| <u>propagation/APPLY.md</u> | 535 | The operator procedure for applying the staged carriers to the five owned submodules — survey, the conditional pointer form and why it differs from the root form, ordering (submodules first, umbrella last), per-submodule commands, post-apply verification, and an explicit list of what it does not do. |
| <u>propagation/RISKS.md</u> | 219 | Blast-radius and honesty register for that procedure: push fan-out per repository, the milosvasic.ru fetch/push asymmetry, the superspec exclusion, and what could not be verified read-only. |

| File | Lines | What it is |
|------------------------------------|-------|---|
| | | <p>Read before running anything in APPLY.md.</p> <p>The §11.4.156 decision record (2026-08-27, revision 2). Why an Override §11.4.156 was structurally unavailable, the four options and the choice, §0's partial reversal (ci.yml → .disabled with gates on a local pre-push hook; pages.yml restored to ACTIVE because it is the sole publish path for a production site; vasic.digital non-compliant at the provider level with no file-level remedy), the §11.4.6 honest boundary on provider-side settings, and what is lost — no server-side enforcement, .git/hooks/ untracked so a fresh clone is unprotected until scripts/pre-push-gates.sh --install is run, and git push --no-verify bypasses the hook.</p> <p>Per-file inventory of every CI surface considered under that decision,</p> |
| <u>DECISION-11-4-156-COMPLY.md</u> | — | |
| CI-INVENTORY-11-4-156.md | — | |

| File | Lines | What it is |
|------|-------|---|
| | | including the ones ruled structurally inert. Produced separately; not present when this index row was written. |

Staged carriers awaiting operator application

19 drafts plus 1 insert-block, none applied. The .staged suffix is required — see §6.A.

| Target submodule | Files |
|------------------|--|
| ai_interviewing | AGENTS.md.staged (25) ·
CLAUDE.md.staged (28) ·
GEMINI.md.staged (25) ·
QWEN.md.staged (25) |
| design-toolkit | AGENTS.md.staged (25) ·
CLAUDE.md.staged (28) ·
GEMINI.md.staged (25) ·
QWEN.md.staged (25) |
| milosvasic.ru | AGENTS.md.staged (25) ·
CLAUDE.md.staged (28) ·
GEMINI.md.staged (25) ·
QWEN.md.staged (25) |
| monetization | AGENTS.md.staged (25) ·
CLAUDE.md.staged (28) ·
GEMINI.md.staged (25) ·
QWEN.md.staged (25) |
| vasic.digital | AGENTS.md.staged (25) ·
CLAUDE.md.staged (28) ·
GEMINI.md.staged (25) ·
QWEN.insert-block.md (17) — a block to insert into the existing 55-line vasic.digital/QWEN.md, never a replacement |

Governed artifacts outside this directory

Not part of docs/constitution-adoption/, but the things it documents:

| Path | Role |
|---|--|
| Constitution.md | The project constitution — §101–§103, owned-submodule set, remotes, open conflicts, known-excluded findings, gap table |
| CLAUDE.md · AGENTS.md · QWEN.md · GEMINI.md | The four root agent carriers, byte-identical from line 24 |
| helix-deps.yaml | The §11.4.31 dependency manifest |
| tests/
test_constitution_inheritance.sh | The inheritance gate + its --prove-failure mutation proof |
| scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh | The §11.4.32 validation sweep |
| submodules/constitution/ | The canonical corpus. Read it; do not copy from it |

Related documentation

- [../setup-agents-wizard/README.md](#) — the AI-agents setup wizard, which is what installs and configures the agents that read the root carriers described here.